
BUYER TIP
KNOW WHAT YOU'RE
really buying
Practical advice for BUYERS
TITLE · SURVEY · EASEMENTS · HOA
BUYER & SELLER TIPS
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BUYER TIP

CHARLOTTE METRO, SEPTEMBER 2026.

MEDIAN LIST PRICE	$424,950	−3.1% YoY
PRICE PER SQ FT	$217	−1.4% YoY
NEW LISTINGS	3,742	−7.5% YoY
PENDING LISTINGS	4,681	−5.9% YoY

Whatever the price, check the title and boundaries before you close.

Source: Realtor.com Economic Research, Charlotte-Concord-Gastonia, NC-SC metro, September 2026



BUYER TIP

TITLE MEANS OWNERSHIP.

At closing, the deed shows the seller transferred ownership, or "title," to you.

- Old claims can surface later, like unpaid taxes or unpaid contractors
- A title search reviews the public records before you close
- Title insurance can cover certain claims from before your purchase

BUYER TIP

LENDER'S POLICY VS. OWNER'S.

Two title policies, two different jobs.

- Most lenders require a lender's title policy
- It protects the lender's loan, not your equity
- An owner's policy is optional and can help protect your investment

BUYER TIP

YOU CAN SHOP FOR TITLE.

Title services can usually be shopped, so compare before you choose.

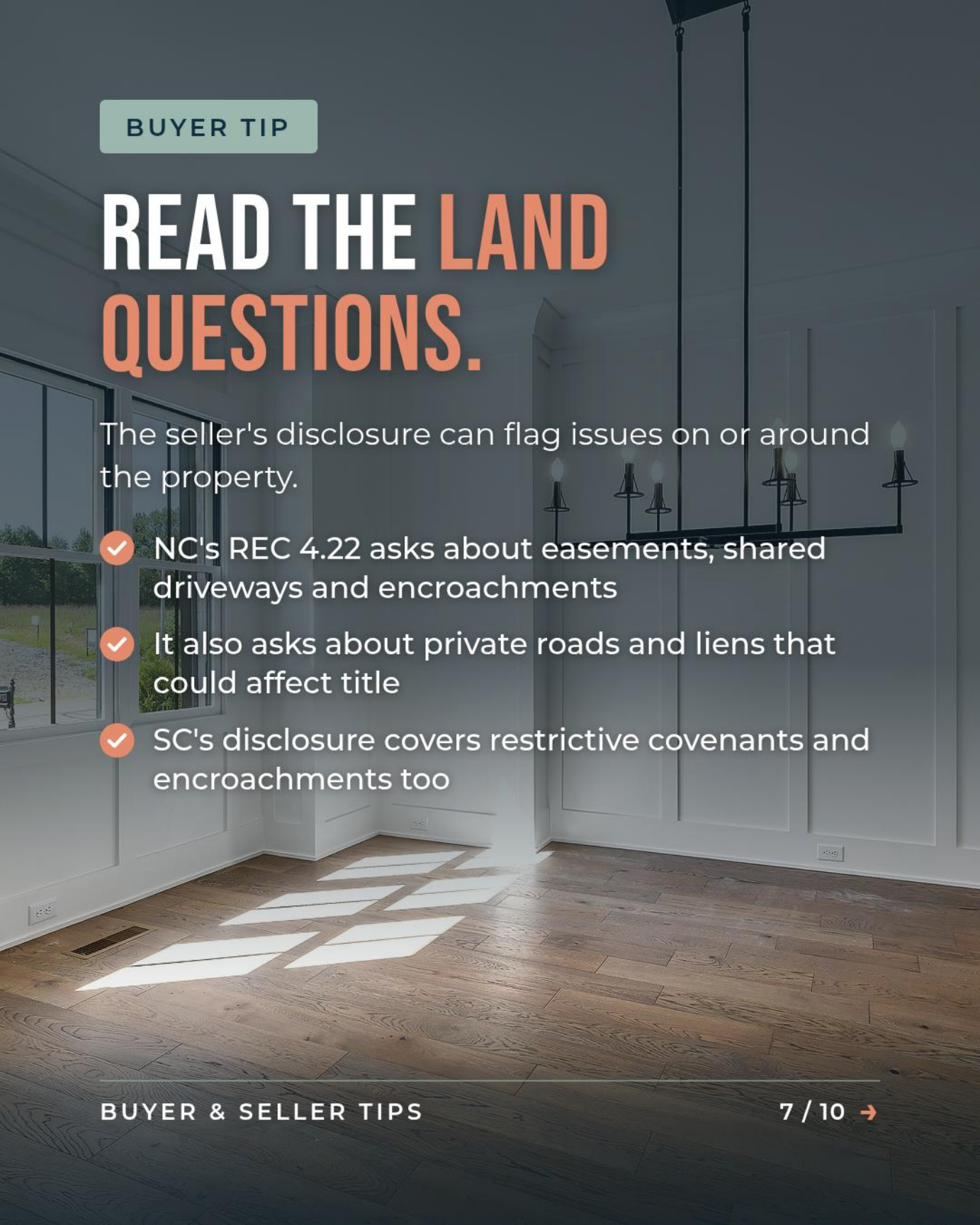
- Look at section C, page 2 of your Loan Estimate
- Your lender must give you a list of local providers
- Buying both policies from one provider usually costs less in total

BUYER TIP

KNOW WHERE THE LINES ARE.

A survey shows what you're buying on the ground, not just on paper.

- A survey can show boundaries, easements and setbacks
- NC's standard offer form lists a survey as a due diligence item
- Order it early so results arrive before your deadline



BUYER TIP

READ THE LAND QUESTIONS.

The seller's disclosure can flag issues on or around the property.

- NC's REC 4.22 asks about easements, shared driveways and encroachments
- It also asks about private roads and liens that could affect title
- SC's disclosure covers restrictive covenants and encroachments too

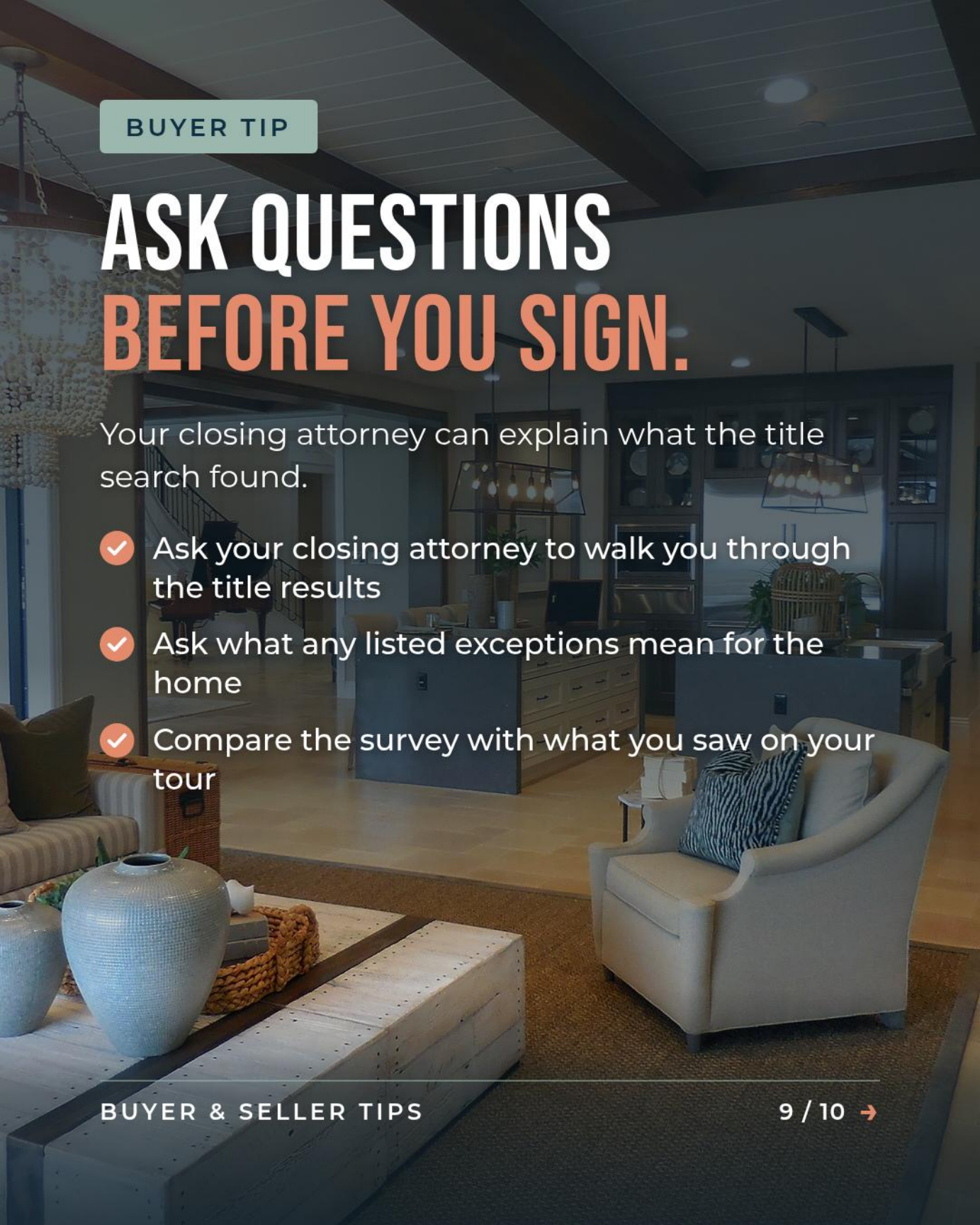


BUYER TIP

READ THE HOA RULES.

Covenants and HOA documents can shape how you use the home and lot.

- Covenants can set mandatory rules for the lot or home
- NC's standard offer form recommends reviewing covenants, bylaws and rules
- Ask if the association charges fees for documents



BUYER TIP

ASK QUESTIONS BEFORE YOU SIGN.

Your closing attorney can explain what the title search found.

- Ask your closing attorney to walk you through the title results
- Ask what any listed exceptions mean for the home
- Compare the survey with what you saw on your tour

LET'S TALK

LET'S TALK.

BUYING IN NC OR SC?

I recommend reviewing the title search, the survey and any HOA documents during due diligence. For legal questions about title, talk with a real estate attorney.

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